Term/Year: Summer 2026
Subject Code and Course Number: CHSS189
Course Title: Gender Perspectives
Number of Credits: 3
Instructor Name: Noor G. Lima Boudakian
Email Address: nlimaboudakian@aua.am
Office Location: 117W PAB
Office Hours: Wednesdays 12:30-13:30 and by appointment
Class Schedule: Monday/Wednesday/Friday 13:30-15:45
Moodle Enrollment Key: Gender

Course Description: This course introduces students to gender as a conceptual tool. It equips the students with perspectives that will enable them to analyze the power relations that constitute what we define as "gender politics." In this course, students will explore the major theoretical discussions within the field of women's, gender and sexuality studies. Students will read, hear, and watch experiences and perspectives from around the globe, with a specific focus on Armenia.

Pre-requisites: None
Co-requisites: None

Required Materials: All required course materials will be provided via Moodle.

Course Structure: Instructor-led class with set times for group work and seminar-style discussions will meet three times per week. Home tasks include readings and reading responses.

Identity: Please call me Noor. If you must refer to me by my last name for your own comfort, please note that my last name is Lima Boudakian (both words). I will ask for your names on the first day of class and will learn them as quickly as possible.

Method of Evaluation: Student learning and the final grade will be calculated based on the following criteria comprising the following percentages.
Attendance/discussion participation—25%
Narrative response papers—25%
Research paper and outline—30%
Reading checks: 20%

Students can expect to receive a grade and feedback on written work within one week of submission.

What it all means:
Attendance means coming to class, on time, and returning on time from the break.

Discussion participation is impossible without attending class, although attendance is insufficient. In addition to lecture time, our class will include seminar-style and small-group discussions.

Receiving credit for these discussions will be assessed based on the following components:

- **Coming to class prepared** having completed the readings, ready to listen and discuss with questions, ideas, and points of disagreement (it is okay to not agree with the authors' analysis!)
- **Engaging with in-class materials and activities** which might look like listening attentively to the speaker, asking questions and respectfully engaging with peers, taking notes, and explaining your train of thought.

Narrative response papers are a type of reading response meant to provide an opportunity for students to critically engage with readings, work through thoughts and ideas through analysis, and offer insights.

Students are expected to submit one reading response at the end of each unit, by class time on the date indicated in the course calendar.

Students will submit reading responses for units 2, 3, 4, 5, 6. Students will not submit a reading response for the first unit, but we will do an in-class analytical comprehension activity instead. The preparation and participation in this activity will mathematically count as one reading response grade.

Response papers are one page in length and narrative in form.

Instructions for response papers will be provided separately on Moodle.

Research paper is an opportunity to delve deeper into a topic of students' choice, related to one of the units that we will cover. It replaces the reading response for one unit.

The paper should be approximately 4 pages long and include at least 3 sources that we have not read in class. Each student should use at least one case study in their argument

Students should write a research question (which I need to approve in advance) and answer it through an analytical argument.

Flow and style are up to each student individually. For example, some students may prefer to analyze policy, while others may choose to conduct a theoretical analysis.

Instructions for the response paper will be provided separately on Moodle.

Reading quizzes are to check for completion of readings, and to hold you accountable to the course calendar. They will be short-answer, 1 to 4 questions and happen at the beginning of class

The quizzes are open note, but no technology may be used. This means you can have your notes, the readings, etc. but can't have a phone or laptop out.

If you do the reading, they will be easy. If you kind of do the reading but skim some parts of it, they will be doable. If you ask an AI what the reading was about, they will be very hard.

I will drop the lowest reading quiz grade. Please do the readings! It can only help you.

Course policies:

Attendance

Attendance is required and will be taken at the beginning of each class. Class starts at 13:30, which means students should be seated and ready to start at 13:30, which is the time that I will take attendance.

Please note that each class of the summer term is equivalent to one week of the regular semester, which means that absences may only be excused in the case of unexpected illness.

Late Policy – Assignments

Reading responses will be accepted up to 24 hours late, *if arrangements have been made in advance via email.*

Reading quizzes will occur in the first few minutes of class and cannot be made up.

I do not provide extra credit assignments, paper re-dos, or quiz retakes.

Communication

For questions, comments, and concerns, students should email me (nlimaboudakian@aua.am) and can expect a response within approximately one working day. If I have not replied by then, feel free to follow up.

If the matter is urgent, please put *urgent* in the subject line.

Updates and other important information will be sent via email and announced/discussed in class.

Technology In the Classroom
Please limit the use of electronic devices to class-related purposes. This means no phones.

I know the urge is strong, but please do *not* check social media, weather, texts, stocks, etc. during class. We all know what you're doing. If there is an emergency you need to be on-line for, tell me before class and I will be glad to make an exception.

Artificial Intelligence and Plagiarism Policy
The basis of my policy on generative artificial intelligence use is that this class is fundamentally about using critical thinking to understand and describe observable phenomena, which is impossible to do with an algorithmically-derived software.

Given that I am grading your articulation of ideas and application of reading comprehension to your own lives, it puts you at a structural disadvantage to use AI to write, or help write, your assignments for this class.

Artificial Intelligence use is *not permitted* for narrative responses.

We will discuss the possibility of using AI in an assistive capacity for research papers during class, and written guidelines will be provided.

Each paper submitted for this course must include a works cited. Plagiarism is the unacknowledged use of someone else's work as one's own (intentional or unintentional). Any ideas that you acquired from other people (including key concepts, phrases, etc) should be acknowledged with proper citation. Signaling how you have come up with your own idea in this manner is expected and valued in academic writing and in this class.

If you are struggling, please speak to me, not to the computer. Please also feel free to use resources such as the writing center.

See the next page for course calendar and readings list!
Course Syllabus is subject to change to address student needs

Date	Unit	Readings	Assignments	Activities
June 15 (M)	1: Intro	1.1		
June 17 (W)	1: Intro	1.2, 1.3		
June 19 (F)	1: Intro	1.4	Decide on paper topic	
June 22 (M)	1/2	-	Reading notes due	Analysis activity
June 24 (W)	2: Labor	2.1		Econ activity
June 26 (F)	2: Labor	2.2		
June 29 (M)	-	-	Outline due	Paper workshop; Care activity
July 1 (W)	3: Care	3.1, 3.2	U2 response due	
July 3 (F)	3: Care	3.3		
July 6 (M)	4: War	4.3, 4.4	U3 response due	
July 8 (W)	4: War	4.1, 4.2		
July 10 (F)	6: Witches	-	Paper draft and sources	Paper workshop; Witches activity
July 13 (M)	5: Witches	5.1	U4 response due	
July 15 (W)	6: Race	5.2		
July 17 (F)	6: Health	6.1	U5 response due	
July 20 (M)	6: Environment	6.2		
July 22 (W)	7: Sex	6.3		
July 24 (F)	7: Sex	7.1	U6 response due	

Unit 1: Introduction/What is Gender, if it Exists?

1 Kincaid, Jamaica. "Girl." The Vintage Book of Contemporary American Short Stories, edited by Tobias Wolff, Vintage, 1994, pp. 306-07. (2 pages)

2 Judith Butler [a few pages from] “Introduction: Gender Ideology and the Fear of Destruction” from Who’s Afraid of Gender? (2024) (10 pages)

3 Simone de Beauvoir “The Second Sex” Introduction (1949) (17 pages)

4 Angela Saini “Inferior: How Science Got Women Wrong” Chapter 5 “Women’s Work” (2017) (26 pages)

Unit 2: Labor, Work, and the Economics of Gender

1 Chapter 4 “Capitalism Between the Sheets: On Sex (Part 1)” from Why Women Have Better Sex Under Socialism by Kristen Ghodsee (2018) (17 pages)

2 Martirosyan, S. (2020, January 30). The Need for Gender Equality in the Labor Market. EVN Report

Optional: “Women and the Culture of Entrepreneurship” Chapter 4 pgs 56-74 by Marta Bruno from Post-Soviet Women: from the Baltic to Central Asia (edited by Mary Buckley) (19 pages)

Optional: Nazaretyan, H. (2021, January 31). Avoiding the Empty Nest: Armenia’s Demographic Security. EVN Report

Unit 3: Care, the Home, and the Family

1 Angela Saini “Alienation” (Chapter 6) from The Patriarchs (2023) (22 pages)

2 Ursula K Leguin, “The Ones Who Walk Away from Omelas” (1973) (5 pages)

3 Kristen Ghodsee “The Red Valkyries” Chapter 2 (“The Communist Valkyrie: Alexandra Kollontai) 2022 (29 pages)

Unit 4: War and Adjacent Ideologies

1 Kathryn Pinnick "When the Fighting is Over: The soldiers' mothers and the Afghan madonnas" from Post-Soviet Women: from the Baltic to Central Asia (edited by Mary Buckley) (13 pages)

2 Avakian, A., & Attarian, H. (2015). Imagining our foremothers: Memory and evidence of women victims and survivors of the Armenian genocide: A dialogue. European Journal of Women's Studies, 476-483. (8 pages)

3 Avetisyan, A. (2021, November 15). Armenia: Mothers Bereaved by War Offered IVF. Retrieved from Institute for War and Peace Reporting. (short news article)

4 Derderian, K. (2004). Common Fate, Different Experience: Gender-Specific Aspect of the Armenian Genocide, 1915-1917. Holocaust and Genocide Studies, 1-25. (16 pages)

Unit 5: Witches

1 Mona Chollet (translated by Sophie R Lewis) Foreword, Introduction, and Chapter 1 (A Life of One's Own: The Scourge of Women's Independence) from In Defense of Witches (2018/tr.2022) (64 pages)

2 Silvia Federici Introduction, part of Chapter 3 (pgs 133-147) "The Great Caliban: The Struggle Against the Rebel Body" from Caliban and the Witch: Women, the Body, and Primitive Accumulation (2004/2014) (15 pages)

Unit 6: Race, Ethnicity, and Environment

1 Caroline Criado Perez, Chapter 4 "Going to the Doctor" "Invisible Women: Exposing Data Bias in a World Designed for Men" (2019) (35 pages)

2 Hugh Ryan "The Women's House of Detention: A Queer History of a Forgotten Prison" (Chapter 2) 2022 (27 pages)

3 TBD

Optional: Deirdre Cooper Owens "Medical Bondage: Race, Gender, and Origins of American Gynecology" (Introduction and chapter 1) 2017 (42 pages)

Unit 7: Sex

Amia Srinivasan "The Right to Sex" from The Right to Sex: Feminism in the Twenty-First Century (2021) (17 pages)

Policy on Grade Appeal

Students are entitled to appeal grades in line with the university's *Grade Policies* policy which is available online at http://policies.aua.am/policy/11

Standards for Academic Integrity

Students are required to conduct themselves in an academically responsible and ethical manner in line with AUA's *Student Code of Ethics.* Acts of academic dishonesty impair the academic integrity of AUA and create an unfair academic advantage for the student involved and other member(s) of the academic community. These acts are subject to disciplinary measures as prescribed in the AUA Student Code of Ethics, http://policies.aua.am/policy/10

The Student Code of Conduct can be found at http://policies.aua.am/policy/101

Special Needs:

Students requesting special accommodations for learning should contact the Office of Student Affairs, studentaffairs@aua.am, https://studentaffairs.aua.am/disability-support-services/ by the end of the Add/Drop period with such requests.

Student Learning Outcomes:

Program Goal	*Program Student LearningOutcomes* *Students will be able to:*	*Course-based Student Learning Outcomes* *In this course, students will be able to:*
Goal 4: Develop articulate, conscientious leaders and problem solvers who are committed to contributing totheir fields and society.	4.2 Think critically and creatively, conceptualizing real-world problemsfrom different perspectives.	- Identify and discuss the fundamentals of Genderand Women's Studies - Recognize differences (and similarities) across categories of gender, and also race, class and sexuality, and how this diversity shapes our dailylives and social relations - Engage in critical and analytical discussions about gender and its impact on human behaviorand choices - Analyze and compare the ways genderperspectives are included in research
	4.3 Work productively in diverse teams and solve problems collaboratively.	- Work collaboratively to analyze and offer solutions to social problems that shape theireveryday lives and social relations
Goal 5: Provide students with a broad foundation ofknowledge and skills and cultivate a commitment tolife-long learning.	5.2 Weigh evidence and arguments, and appreciate and engage in diverse modes of inquiry characteristic of historical, cultural, political, economic, and quantitative disciplines.	- Incorporate conventional knowledge into new ideological perspectives.